

Late Deliveries, Lost Customers

Why customers give bad reviews, and what to fix first

14.6%

of reviewed orders get a 1–2 star review (14,382 of 98,330)

Broken delivery promises and incomplete orders account for the avoidable bad reviews. Orders that arrive late or not at all are 9.5% of orders but 42.7% of all 1–2 star reviews, and orders with several items often arrive incomplete. Complete orders and on-time delivery in the five worst states could remove about 1,600 bad reviews, 11% of the total.

WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

1 A broken delivery promise is the strongest driver of bad reviews

62.4% of late orders and 78.0% of orders that never arrive get 1–2 stars, against 9.2% of on-time orders.

2 The delay arises in transit on specific routes, not with a few bad sellers

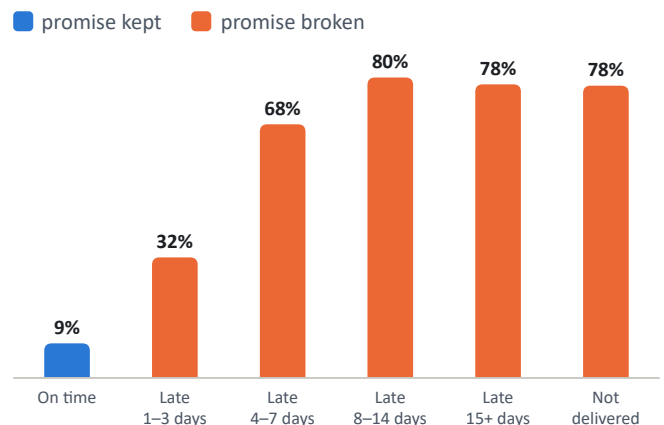
Rio de Janeiro has 12.9% of orders but 22.9% of late deliveries. 72% of late orders left the seller in time, then spent a median 26 days in transit, against 7 days.

3 Orders with several items arrive on time, but often incomplete

24.6% get 1–2 stars, against 7.5% of single-item orders. In 300 coded reviews, 81% of the complaints in this group (95% CI 69–90%) say part of the order is missing.

BAD REVIEWS BY DELIVERY OUTCOME

Share of reviewed orders with a 1–2 star review



WHAT TO DO FIRST

1 Make every order complete, and measure it

About 1,151 fewer bad reviews (768–1,535). First step: audit 100 several-item orders marked as delivered. Sent later, or never sent?

2 Fix transit on the worst routes

About 457 fewer bad reviews (305–610). First step: a carrier scorecard for Rio de Janeiro and the Northeast, and a review of the promised dates there.

3 Warn customers before a missed promise

Not quantified: needs a test. Bad reviews go from 32% at 1–3 days late to 68% at 4–7 days: the first days after the promised date are the window to act.

WHAT FIXING IT COULD ACHIEVE

Estimated 1–2 star reviews avoided over 20 months, of 14,382

On-time delivery in the five worst states

457 (305–610)

Complete orders with several items

1,151 (768–1,535)

Both together

1,609 (1,072–2,145)

Bar: base case, 75% of the observed difference between the groups is a real effect. Line: low case (50%) to high case (100%).

14.6% → 13.0%

share of 1–2 star reviews if both are done, base case

HOW IT WAS DONE

99,092 orders, January 2017 to August 2018. SQL star schema in DuckDB from 9 raw tables, with 32 documented data quality decisions, 37 validation tests and 13 KPI definitions. 12 hypotheses from an issue tree, each tested with data. A stratified random sample of 300 bad reviews, coded with a codebook of 8 complaint types. A scenario with low, base and high cases. Power BI dashboard and 10-slide deck built from the same numbers.

WHAT TO KEEP IN MIND

Observational data: the findings are strong associations, not proven effects, and the scenario is an estimate, not a forecast. The review survey is sent around the promised date, so most late customers answer while still waiting. Impact is counted in reviews, not in money: costs are not in the data. The reviews were coded by one coder; only customers who wrote a comment are represented.